90 DAYS READY

THE 90-DAY HOME READINESS KIT

Water, food, power, money and a family plan, built in four stages you can buy one payday at a time.

72 HOURS	2 WEEKS	30 DAYS	90 DAYS
Stage 1	Stage 2	Stage 3	Stage 4

- ✓ Household needs calculator
- ✓ Four stage-by-stage checklists
- ✓ Water storage & purification card
- ✓ Pantry inventory & rotation log
- ✓ Power-out & winter safety
- ✓ Internet & phones-down plan
- ✓ Family emergency plan
- ✓ 12-month upkeep calendar

13 pages · US Letter · print & fill in

READY ONE PAYDAY AT A TIME

START HERE

HOW THIS KIT WORKS

Nobody builds 90 days of supplies in a weekend. You build it in layers, and every layer is useful on its own.

72 HRS
A storm, an ice day, a short outage

2 WKS
Roads closed, stores empty, lines down

30 DAYS
A lost paycheck, a long recovery

90 DAYS
A long disruption to supply or income

THREE RULES

- [ ] **Finish one stage before you start the next.** A complete 72-hour kit beats half of a 90-day one.
- [ ] **Buy what you already eat and use.** Then you can rotate it into normal life and nothing goes to waste.
- [ ] **Add a little every payday.** Pick an amount you can keep up (even $10–$20) and spend it from the next stage's list.

THE TWO-WEEK COUNT (THE EASIEST WAY TO GET YOUR REAL NUMBERS)

Every home uses toilet paper, soap, diapers, pet food and coffee at its own rate. Don't guess. For two normal weeks, count how much your household actually uses, then:

> **2 weeks × 2 = 30 days | 2 weeks × 6.5 = 90 days**
> Example: you use 9 rolls of toilet paper in two weeks → about 59 rolls for 90 days.

Write your counts on the calculator page (page 3) and every shopping list in this kit gets its real numbers.

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM

Water and purification amounts follow U.S. CDC, EPA and Ready.gov household guidance. Fridge and freezer times follow USDA food-safety guidance. Calorie planning uses about 2,000 calories per adult per day as a planning figure; adjust for children, older adults and hard physical work.

> **Please read:** This kit is a planning and organizing tool, not medical, legal or professional advice. Always follow instructions from your local officials and emergency services. Ask your doctor or pharmacist before changing how you store or take any medication.

HOUSEHOLD NEEDS CALCULATOR

Fill this in once. Every stage list in this kit points back to these numbers.

Adults _____ Children _____ Pets (kind & size) _____

WATER: 1 GALLON PER PERSON PER DAY (DRINKING + BASIC HYGIENE)

People	72 hours (×3)	2 weeks (×14)	30 days (×30)	90 days (×90)
	gal	gal	gal	gal

Plus extra for pets (ask your vet how much your pet drinks), hot weather, nursing mothers and anyone sick. Ninety days of water is a lot: one person needs about 90 gallons. Most homes store 2 weeks and plan how to treat more (page 8).

FOOD: ABOUT 2,000 CALORIES PER ADULT PER DAY

People	72 hours	2 weeks	30 days	90 days
	6,000 per adult	28,000 per adult	60,000 per adult	180,000 per adult

Tip: the calories are on every label. A jar of peanut butter is about 2,500–3,000; a 1 lb bag of rice is about 1,600 dry.

YOUR TWO-WEEK COUNTS

Item	Used in 2 weeks	× 2 = 30 days	× 6.5 = 90 days	Have now
Toilet paper (rolls)				
Paper towels / wipes				
Soap, shampoo, toothpaste				
Diapers / period products				
Trash bags				
Dish soap / laundry soap				
Pet food (lbs or cans)				
Coffee / tea / baby formula				
Batteries (by size)				

STAGE 1 OF 4

72 HOURS

The kit every home should have. It covers most storms, ice days and short power outages.

WATER & FOOD

- [ ] 3 gallons of water per person
- [ ] 3 days of food that needs no cooking
- [ ] Manual can opener (keep two)
- [ ] Paper plates, cups, utensils
- [ ] 3 days of pet food and water
- [ ] Baby formula and baby food, if needed

LIGHT, POWER & INFORMATION

- [ ] Flashlight or headlamp for each person
- [ ] Extra batteries for each device
- [ ] Battery or hand-crank radio (NOAA weather band)
- [ ] Charged power bank + phone cables
- [ ] Car phone charger

HEALTH & HYGIENE

- [ ] First-aid kit
- [ ] 7 days of each prescription medicine
- [ ] Pain reliever, allergy medicine
- [ ] Spare glasses or contacts
- [ ] Toilet paper, wipes, hand sanitizer
- [ ] Trash bags and zip-top bags

SAFETY & MONEY

- [ ] Smoke and carbon monoxide alarms tested
- [ ] Fire extinguisher
- [ ] Whistle, work gloves, duct tape
- [ ] Some cash in small bills
- [ ] Copies of IDs and insurance cards
- [ ] Know how to shut off your water and gas

> **Done when:** you could lose power and water for three days starting right now and never leave the house.

STAGE 2 OF 4

2 WEEKS

The American Red Cross suggests a 2-week supply for staying at home.

WATER

- [ ] 14 gallons of water per person
- [ ] A way to treat more water: unscented bleach, a filter, or a pot and fuel to boil (page 8)
- [ ] Clean containers to fill when a storm is named

FOOD

- [ ] 2 weeks of shelf-stable food you already eat
- [ ] A way to cook without power (camp stove used **outdoors only**, or grill)
- [ ] Fuel for that stove
- [ ] Comfort foods, coffee, drink mixes

POWER

- [ ] Lanterns (battery, not candles if you can)
- [ ] Extra power banks, or a portable power station
- [ ] Generator, if you choose one: read the safety rules on page 10 first

HEALTH & HYGIENE

- [ ] 14 days of each prescription (ask your pharmacist about early refills)
- [ ] 2 weeks of toilet paper, soap, diapers, period products (your Two-Week Count)
- [ ] Bucket, heavy trash bags and kitty litter for a backup toilet
- [ ] Disinfecting wipes and bleach

WARMTH (WINTER)

- [ ] Warm blankets or sleeping bags for each person
- [ ] Hats, gloves, wool socks
- [ ] Pipe insulation; know where your main water shutoff is

MONEY & PAPERS

- [ ] Cash for 2 weeks of essentials, small bills
- [ ] Important documents in a waterproof bag (page 11)
- [ ] Gas tank kept at least half full

STAGE 3 OF 4

30 DAYS

Now you are covering more than storms: a lost paycheck, a long illness, or shortages at the store.

FOOD: THE DEEP PANTRY

- [ ] 30 days of food (your calorie number, page 3)
- [ ] Staples: rice, dried beans, oats, pasta, flour
- [ ] Protein: canned meat and fish, peanut butter
- [ ] Canned fruit and vegetables
- [ ] Cooking oil, salt, sugar, spices
- [ ] Multivitamin
- [ ] Pantry inventory started (page 9)

WATER

- [ ] Water filter rated for bacteria and protozoa
- [ ] Spare filter cartridges
- [ ] Large food-grade storage containers

HOUSEHOLD

- [ ] 30 days of every Two-Week Count item (× 2)
- [ ] 30 days of pet food and litter
- [ ] Basic tools: hammer, screwdrivers, pliers, tarp, rope
- [ ] Spare light bulbs, batteries, matches

HEALTH

- [ ] Ask your doctor or insurer whether you can get a 90-day supply of regular medicines
- [ ] Written list of every medicine and dose for each person (page 12)
- [ ] Fuller first-aid kit and a first-aid guide

MONEY

- [ ] One month of bills written down with due dates
- [ ] Emergency savings goal set: _____

STAGE 4 OF 4

90 DAYS

The long game. Grow it slowly from Stage 3 and rotate it so nothing expires.

FOOD

- [ ] 90 days of food (your calorie number, page 3)
- [ ] Bulk staples stored in sealed, pest-proof containers
- [ ] Rotation system in use: oldest first (page 9)
- [ ] Seeds and a small garden plan (optional)

WATER

- [ ] As much stored water as you can safely keep
- [ ] A plan for more: filter + bleach + boil, rain barrel for non-drinking use

HOUSEHOLD

- [ ] 90 days of every Two-Week Count item (× 6.5)
- [ ] 90 days of pet supplies
- [ ] Laundry by hand: bucket, plunger or washboard

POWER & HEAT

- [ ] A longer backup power plan (solar panel for a power station, or stored generator fuel rotated safely)
- [ ] A safe backup heat plan for one room (page 10)

HEALTH

- [ ] Regular medicines on 90-day refills where your plan allows
- [ ] Dental care, OTC medicines, hygiene for 90 days

MONEY & SKILLS

- [ ] Cash reserve: _____
- [ ] Paper copies of accounts and contacts (page 11)
- [ ] One new skill each month: canning, first aid/CPR, basic repair
- [ ] Neighbors you can count on, and who can count on you

> **Remember:** stored food and water only help if they are still good. A smaller supply you rotate beats a big one you forget.

REFERENCE CARD

WATER: STORE IT, TREAT IT

Cut this page out and tape it inside a cabinet.

STORING WATER

- [ ] Plan on **1 gallon per person per day**.
- [ ] Store-bought bottled water is the easiest. Keep it sealed and check its date.
- [ ] If you fill your own containers, use food-grade containers and replace the water about every 6 months.
- [ ] Store it cool, dark, and away from gasoline, chemicals and pesticides.
- [ ] When a storm is coming, fill clean containers and bathtubs (tub water is for flushing and washing).

TREATING WATER YOU'RE NOT SURE ABOUT

1 · BOIL (BEST)

If water is cloudy, let it settle and filter it through a clean cloth first. Bring it to a **rolling boil for 1 minute** (3 minutes above 6,500 feet). Let it cool. Store it in clean containers with covers.

2 · BLEACH (IF YOU CAN'T BOIL)

Use plain, unscented household bleach. Check the label for the strength. Stir, then **wait at least 30 minutes** before drinking.

Bleach strength on the label	Clear water, per gallon	Cloudy or very cold water, per gallon
5–6% sodium hypochlorite	**8 drops** (about 1/8 teaspoon)	**16 drops** (about 1/4 teaspoon)
8.25% sodium hypochlorite	**6 drops**	**12 drops**

Source: U.S. CDC and EPA emergency drinking-water guidance. Don't use scented, color-safe or "splash-less" bleach.

3 · FILTER

A portable filter removes many germs, but most do not remove viruses. If the filter's label doesn't say it handles viruses, also boil or add bleach.

> **Boiling and bleach do not remove chemicals, fuel or heavy metals.** Toxic algae toxins are not made safe by boiling either. If you think water is contaminated with chemicals or floodwater, don't drink it. Find another source.

INVENTORY

PANTRY INVENTORY & ROTATION LOG

First in, first out: put new cans behind old ones and eat the oldest first.

Item	Qty	Calories each	Total calories	Best by	Where stored

Pantry total: _____ calories ÷ _____ people ÷ 2,000 = _____ days of food

WHEN THE POWER GOES OUT

POWER-OUT & WINTER SAFETY

In Texas's February 2021 freeze, the cold itself killed the most people (158 of 246 deaths); carbon monoxide killed 19. Plan for both.

Carbon monoxide kills. Never run a generator, grill, camp stove or charcoal inside your home, garage, basement or carport, even with the door open. Keep a generator **at least 20 feet** from windows, doors and vents. Never heat your home with an oven or gas stove. Have a battery-powered or battery-backup CO alarm.

FOOD IN THE FRIDGE

- [ ] Keep the doors closed.
- [ ] A closed fridge keeps food cold for about **4 hours**.
- [ ] A full freezer holds about **48 hours** (24 if half full).
- [ ] Use a thermometer: food above 40°F for over 2 hours should be thrown out.
- [ ] When in doubt, throw it out.

PIPES IN A FREEZE

- [ ] Let faucets on outside walls drip.
- [ ] Open cabinet doors under sinks.
- [ ] Insulate exposed pipes; cover outdoor spigots.
- [ ] Know where your main water shutoff is: _____

STAYING WARM SAFELY

- [ ] Pick one small interior room. Close it off with towels at the doors.
- [ ] Layer clothes, hats, blankets; sleep together.
- [ ] Only use heaters made for indoor use, and follow the label.
- [ ] Keep anything that burns 3 feet from heaters.
- [ ] If your home gets dangerously cold, go to a warming center or a warm friend's house. Older adults and babies chill fastest.

DURING THE OUTAGE

- [ ] Unplug electronics to protect them from the surge when power returns.
- [ ] Leave one lamp on so you know when it's back.
- [ ] Check on older neighbors.
- [ ] Report downed lines; stay far away from them.

My utility's outage number: _____

Sources: U.S. CDC carbon-monoxide guidance; USDA food safety during power outages; Ready.gov winter weather; Texas DSHS February 2021 winter storm mortality report.

IF THE INTERNET OR PHONES GO DOWN

YOUR OFFLINE PLAN

An outage, a cyberattack, a cell tower down: your phone holds your whole life. Put the important parts on paper.

ACCOUNTS ON PAPER (NO PASSWORDS HERE: STORE THOSE SEPARATELY AND SAFELY)

Bank / card / bill	Phone number	Account ends in	Branch / address

BEFORE IT HAPPENS

- [ ] Print the contacts page (page 12)
- [ ] Keep cash for days when card readers are down
- [ ] Print your account login backup codes; lock them away
- [ ] Copy key documents to a USB drive; keep it in your document bag
- [ ] Download offline maps of your area on your phone
- [ ] Have a paper road map
- [ ] Learn to open your garage door by hand

DOCUMENT BAG (WATERPROOF)

- [ ] IDs, passports, Social Security cards (copies)
- [ ] Birth and marriage certificates
- [ ] Insurance policies: home, auto, health, life
- [ ] Deed or lease, mortgage papers
- [ ] Medical info and medicine lists
- [ ] Pet vaccine records and photos
- [ ] Photos of your home's contents for insurance

> Watch out for scams after any big outage or disaster: texts and calls claiming to be your bank, a utility or a government agency. Call back on a number you wrote on this page, never one they give you.

FILL IN TOGETHER

FAMILY EMERGENCY PLAN

Make sure everyone in the house knows this page exists, and keep a copy in each car.

Name	Cell	Medicines & doses	Allergies / conditions

MEETING PLACES

Right outside our home: _____

In our neighborhood: _____

Out of town: _____

IMPORTANT CONTACTS

Who	Name	Phone
Out-of-state contact (everyone calls them)		
Doctor		
Pharmacy		
Vet		
Schools / daycare		
Work		
Neighbor		
Insurance agent		
Utility (power / water / gas)		

Texting often works when calls won't go through. Agree now: if we're split up, we text the out-of-state contact first.

KEEP IT FRESH

12-MONTH UPKEEP CALENDAR

Ten minutes on the first weekend of each month. Check the box when done.

Month	This month's job	Done
January	Test smoke and CO alarms. Check winter supplies and pipe insulation.	
February	Pantry inventory: eat and replace the oldest 10 items.	
March	Check batteries in flashlights, radio and lanterns.	
April	Replace stored tap water (6-month cycle). Check the first-aid kit.	
May	Storm season prep: tarps, yard cleanup, document bag up to date.	
June	Run and service the generator or charge the power station.	
July	Test smoke and CO alarms. Update the family plan and contacts.	
August	Pantry inventory: eat and replace the oldest 10 items.	
September	Check medicines, glasses and medical supplies for expiry.	
October	Replace stored tap water. Winter prep: blankets, heaters checked.	
November	Redo your Two-Week Count. Update your shopping lists.	
December	Refresh the cash reserve. Practice the family plan once.	

Next stage I'm building: _____ **Every payday I'll add:** $_____

BONUS · 90 DAYS READY

THE PAYCHECK PLAN

What to buy with each paycheck, in order. About $25–40 a paycheck gets one adult to two weeks ready in eight paychecks.

Shopping list with links: preparedathome.netlify.app/paycheck-plan

STAGE 1 — 72 HOURS

Paychecks 1–4 · about $130 per adult

PAYCHECK 1 — ~$25

- ☐ 3 gallons of water per person — $4
- ☐ Manual can opener — $5
- ☐ Flashlight or headlamp + batteries — $15

PAYCHECK 2 — ~$30

- ☐ 3 days of no-cook food: peanut butter, crackers, canned chicken or tuna, cereal, fruit cups — $20
- ☐ Paper plates, cups, utensils — $5
- ☐ Trash bags and zip-top bags — $5

PAYCHECK 3 — ~$35

- ☐ First-aid kit — $15
- ☐ Pain reliever, allergy medicine — $10
- ☐ Toilet paper, wipes, hand sanitizer — $10

PAYCHECK 4 — ~$40

- ☐ Battery or hand-crank radio (NOAA band) — $25
- ☐ Power bank + phone cable — $15

FREE, ANY WEEK — $0

- ☐ Test smoke and carbon monoxide alarms
- ☐ Photo or copy of IDs and insurance cards
- ☐ Learn where your water and gas shut off
- ☐ Fill clean bottles with tap water, label the date (page 8)

STAGE 2 — 2 WEEKS

Paychecks 5–8 · about $130 per adult

PAYCHECK 5 — ~$30

- ☐ 11 more gallons of water per person, or 2 refillable water jugs — $15–25
- ☐ Plain unscented bleach (page 8) — $4

PAYCHECK 6 — ~$30

- ☐ Week 1 of shelf-stable food you already eat — $25
- ☐ Coffee, drink mixes, a comfort food — $5

PAYCHECK 7 — ~$35

- ☐ Week 2 of shelf-stable food — $25
- ☐ Battery lantern — $10

PAYCHECK 8 — ~$35

- ☐ 2 weeks of your Two-Week Count items (page 3) — $20
- ☐ Extra batteries or a second power bank — $15
- ☐ Ask your pharmacist about early refills — $0

Can't spare $25? Do the free list first, then buy one line per paycheck. Stage 1 is 11 lines, so you still reach 72 hours in about five months of paychecks, and every item helps on its own.
Also on the Stage 1 list (page 4) if your home needs them: 7 days of prescriptions, pet food, baby supplies, spare glasses, a fire extinguisher.

BONUS · 90 DAYS READY

AFTER STAGE 2: THE RHYTHM

From here it's one habit, not a shopping list. Add a little to every grocery trip and let it build.

STAGE 3 · 30 DAYS — Paychecks 9–14

- ☐ Add $15–20 of staples to each grocery run: rice, dried beans, oats, pasta, canned meat
- ☐ One paycheck: a water filter rated for bacteria and protozoa (page 6)
- ☐ Buy 30 days of your Two-Week Count items (× 2), a few each trip
- ☐ Start the pantry log (page 9)

STAGE 4 · 90 DAYS — Paychecks 15–30

- ☐ Same rhythm, $15–25 a paycheck, toward 90 days (× 6.5)
- ☐ Sealed, pest-proof containers for bulk staples
- ☐ Eat the oldest first, replace it on the next trip
- ☐ Ask about 90-day refills for regular medicines

Rule of thumb: buy only what your household already eats and uses. A stocked pantry you rotate is worth more than a stack of food nobody likes.

PAYCHECK	DATE	BUDGET	WHAT I BOUGHT	STAGE	DONE
1				72 hours	☐
2				72 hours	☐
3				72 hours	☐
4				72 hours	☐
5				2 weeks	☐
6				2 weeks	☐
7				2 weeks	☐
8				2 weeks	☐
9				30 days	☐
10				30 days	☐
11				30 days	☐
12				30 days	☐
13				30 days	☐
14				30 days	☐